

» Minor, augmented, and diminished intervals

In addition to major and perfect intervals, the other qualities of intervals are minor, augmented, and diminished. Perfect intervals can only become augmented or diminished, but major intervals can become minor, augmented, or diminished.

What happens to perfect intervals?

If the top note of a perfect interval moves up a half step, the interval becomes augmented. If the top note moves down a half step, the interval becomes diminished.

▽ Changing perfect intervals

This flowchart shows how a perfect interval becomes an augmented interval when the top note moves up a half step, and becomes a diminished interval when the top note moves down a half step.



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◁ **Diminished 8ve**
On this staff, the top note of a perfect octave moves down a half step to make the octave diminished.

33

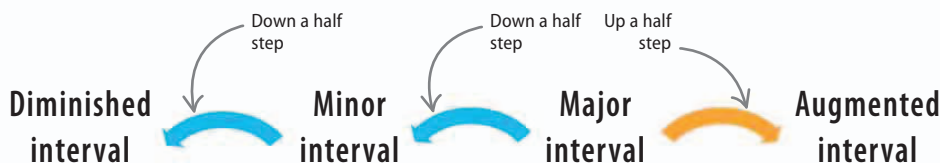
◁ **Augmented 4th**
On this staff, the top note of a perfect 4th moves up a half step to make it an augmented 4th.

What happens to major intervals?

Just like perfect intervals, major intervals become augmented if their top note moves up a half step. However, if the top note of a major interval moves down one half step, it becomes a minor interval. If it moves down two half steps, the interval becomes diminished.

◁ Changing major intervals

The top note of a major interval moves up one half step to make it an augmented interval, and moves down one half step to make it a minor interval. The top note moves down two half steps to make it a diminished interval.



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△ **Major 2nd**
The top note of a major 2nd moves up a half step to make it an augmented 2nd, and it moves down a half step to make it a minor 2nd. It moves down two half steps to make it a diminished 2nd.

35

△ **Minor 7th**
If the top note of a major 7th moves down one half step, the interval becomes a minor 7th. An augmented and diminished 7th are also shown on this staff.